



Put It in Order

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children sequence four steps into the correct order (fewest to most). Arranging several steps in order is the heart of building an algorithm — a plan a computer can follow step by step.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children order a multi-step process.

No reading required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child writes 1-4 and draws.

Materials

The printed worksheet + a pencil. Optional: cards with 1-4 dots to lay out in order by hand.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: count the in-order plant — 'one leaf, two, three, four.' The count grows by one each day.
2. GUIDED: Exercise 1 — number the mixed cards by counting leaves (fewest = 1).
3. YOU TRY: children mark first and last (Ex 2), then draw day 5 with five leaves (Ex 3).
4. Connect: 'A plan of ordered steps is an algorithm — computers follow them in order.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Model — in order: 1 leaf, 2 leaves, 3 leaves, 4 leaves.

Ex 1 — under the mixed cards [4, 2, 1, 3 leaves] write [4, 2, 1, 3].

Ex 2 — circle the 1-leaf card (first); X on the 4-leaf card (last).

Ex 3 — draw a step with 5 leaves (▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲).

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: numbering left-to-right by position — have them count leaves before writing.

Simplify: order three cards (1-3) before four.

Extend: shuffle and re-order, or order steps of a real routine (wash, dry, etc.).

Movement option: hand four children 1-4 objects and have them line up in order.

Success looks like

The child numbers the four steps 1-4 by count and draws a correct five-leaf next step.